

PROPOSAL TO HOST THE ATLANTIC AI SUMMIT 2027

In Association With:



Author:

Andrew McIntyre, Ph.D.



ACADIA INSTITUTE FOR DATA ANALYTICS (AIDA)
ACADIA UNIVERSITY

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Executive Summary

Acadia University is pleased to submit this proposal to host the **Atlantic AI Summit 2027**, to be held **June 9–11, 2027**, in Wolfville, Nova Scotia. Building on the success of previous Summits, Acadia looks forward to welcoming the Atlantic AI community for three days of collaboration, innovation, and meaningful engagement.

The Atlantic AI Summit has become an important forum for bringing together the people who are advancing artificial intelligence throughout Atlantic Canada. Researchers, students, entrepreneurs, industry leaders, government representatives, and community organizations come together to exchange ideas, establish new partnerships, showcase emerging technologies, and explore how AI can address opportunities and challenges across the region.

Acadia University is well positioned to host the 2027 Summit through its growing leadership in applied artificial intelligence, strong regional partnerships, and commitment to research, innovation, education, and community engagement. The Summit will be coordinated through the Acadia Institute for Data Analytics (AIDA), with support from the Jodrey School of Computer Science, Events Acadia, and the University's professional administrative services.

Interested members of the Atlantic AI Research Consortium (AIARC) will be welcomed as collaborators in areas such as keynote recruitment, sponsorship development, regional outreach, and promotion. Their participation will broaden engagement from across Atlantic Canada while Acadia University provides overall coordination and accountability for the successful delivery of the Summit.

Hosting the Atlantic AI Summit is about more than providing conference facilities. It is an opportunity to strengthen Atlantic Canada's AI ecosystem by bringing together the people, ideas, and partnerships that continue to shape its future. Acadia is excited to provide a welcoming environment where these conversations can flourish.

Why Host the Summit at Acadia?

Artificial intelligence has become one of Acadia University's defining research strengths through the leadership of the Acadia Institute for Data Analytics (AIDA) and The Jodrey School of Computer Science. Working closely with industry, government, healthcare organizations, community partners, and academic institutions, AIDA has developed collaborative relationships that supports applied AI research, technology adoption, and knowledge mobilization throughout Atlantic Canada. These partnerships provide an excellent foundation for hosting the Summit. Acadia combines an active research environment with experienced institutional support and meaningful regional connections that naturally complement the collaborative goals of the Atlantic AI Summit. Hosting the Summit at Acadia provides an opportunity to strengthen relationships across Atlantic Canada's AI ecosystem while showcasing the region's growing strengths in research, innovation, entrepreneurship, education, and commercialization.

Acadia has a long tradition of interdisciplinary collaboration and community engagement. Faculty, staff, and students regularly work alongside organizations across the region on applied research and innovation projects that address practical challenges while creating economic and societal impact. These partnerships provide delegates with opportunities to engage not only with leading research, but also with examples of AI successfully supporting organizations throughout Atlantic Canada.

Student engagement is central to the University's mission. Undergraduate and graduate students will have opportunities to participate as volunteers, presenters, organizers, and attendees, engaging directly with researchers, entrepreneurs, industry leaders, and policy makers. These experiences strengthen the next generation of AI researchers and practitioners while reinforcing the Summit's educational mission.

Acadia also offers an outstanding conference environment. Its compact, walkable campus places lecture theaters, breakout rooms, residences, dining facilities, exhibition space, and parking within minutes of one another, allowing delegates to focus on collaboration, networking, and knowledge exchange. Combined with

the welcoming community of Wolfville and the natural beauty of the Annapolis Valley, Acadia provides a memorable setting that complements the technical program.

Organizing the Summit

Acadia University will coordinate the planning and delivery of the Summit through the Acadia Institute for Data Analytics (AIDA) and Jodrey School of Computer Science.

Events Acadia brings extensive experience coordinating academic conferences and campus events, providing professional support for venue management, registration, accommodations, and on-site logistics. Communications and outreach will be coordinated through AIDA in collaboration with the Jodrey School of Computer Science and the Office of Industry and Community Engagement. Financial administration will be managed using established University procedures, ensuring clear governance and accountability.

Acadia welcomes participation from interested members of AIARC, who may contribute by identifying keynote speakers, facilitating sponsorship opportunities, promoting the Summit through their networks, and encouraging participation from across the Atlantic AI community. This collaborative model combines clear institutional leadership with broad regional participation while drawing upon the expertise and perspectives of colleagues from across Atlantic Canada.

The Delegate Experience

The proposed dates of **June 9–11, 2027** coincide with full summer availability of Acadia University’s conference facilities while showcasing Wolfville and the Annapolis Valley during one of the region’s most beautiful seasons.

Participants will enjoy a program of keynote presentations, technical sessions, workshops, panel discussions, student programming, industry engagement, exhibitions, and networking opportunities that reflect the diversity of Atlantic Canada’s AI community. Throughout the three days, delegates will have opportunities to exchange ideas, establish collaborations, and connect with colleagues from across the region.

Acadia’s compact campus naturally encourages interaction. Coffee breaks, receptions, and informal gatherings all take place within a short walking distance, creating an environment where conversations continue well beyond scheduled presentations. These informal interactions often become the foundation for future research collaborations, student opportunities, and industry partnerships.

Beyond the technical program, delegates will be invited to participate in optional networking activities including guided Annapolis Valley winery tours and a group hike to Cape Split Provincial Park or Blue Beach. These experiences provide opportunities to strengthen professional relationships while highlighting the hospitality, culture, and natural beauty of the region.

Conclusion

The Atlantic AI Summit reflects the collaborative spirit of Atlantic Canada’s AI community. Each year it provides an opportunity to share ideas, celebrate innovation, strengthen partnerships, and inspire future collaboration across the region.

Acadia University would be honoured to host the 2027 Summit and to welcome delegates to Wolfville on **June 9–11, 2027**. Through the leadership of the Acadia Institute for Data Analytics (AIDA), the support of experienced University services, and the participation of collaborators from across Atlantic Canada, Acadia is well prepared to deliver a welcoming, engaging, and professionally organized event.

We look forward to providing an environment where new ideas emerge, lasting partnerships are formed, students engage with leaders in the field, and the Atlantic AI community comes together to celebrate the remarkable progress being made throughout our region. We hope to welcome you to Wolfville in June 2027.